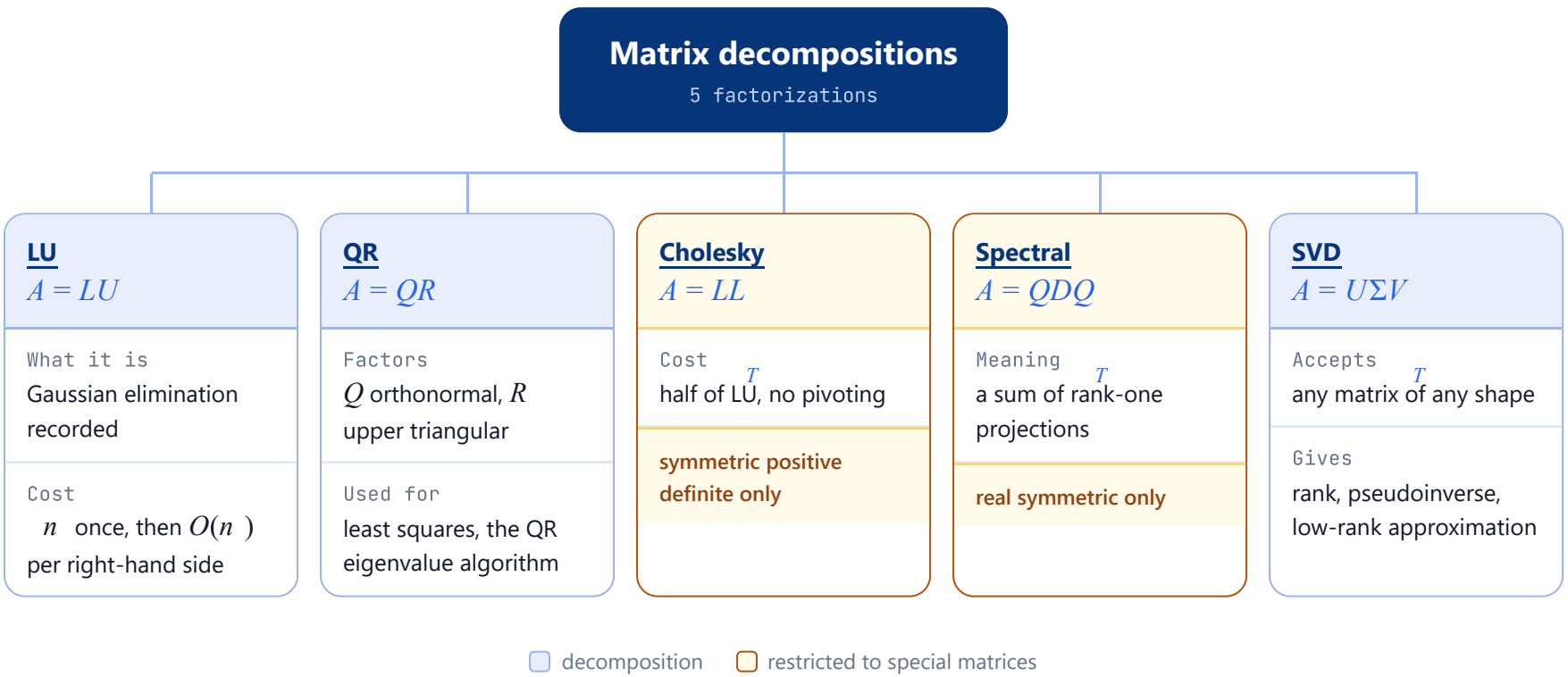
BEFORE YOU READ

Five ways to factor a matrix

Each decomposition writes a matrix as a product of simpler pieces. They differ in which matrices they accept and what they are used for.



TAKEAWAY

Pick by the matrix you have

Cholesky and the spectral decomposition need symmetric matrices; the SVD accepts any matrix of any shape.